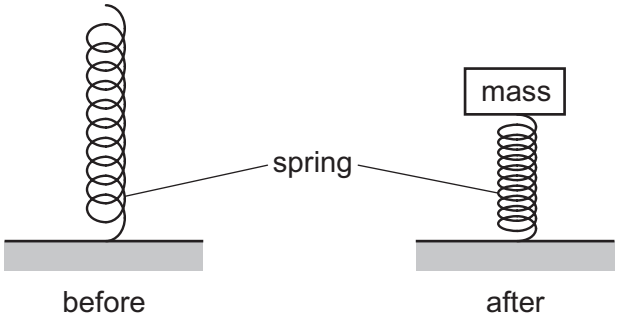
16 A spring is compressed by a mass, as shown.



Which statement describes the changes to the energy of the spring when it is compressed by the mass?

A The spring gains both gravitational potential energy and elastic potential energy.

B The spring gains gravitational potential energy and loses elastic potential energy.

C The spring loses both gravitational potential energy and elastic potential energy.

D The spring loses gravitational potential energy and gains elastic potential energy.